

- The State of Knowledge Report 2026

About Us



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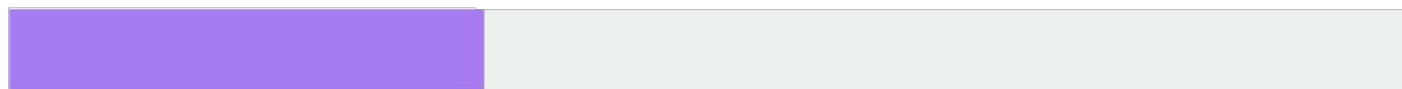
Agents are outnumbering humans 2:1

Agent and human readership of Mintlify-powered sites

257M Agent web requests



131M Human page loads



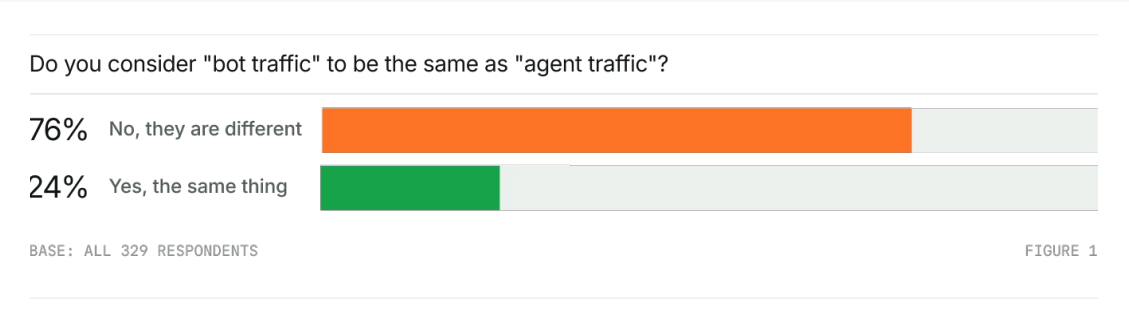
AUGUST 2026

FIGURE 2

×9.3 agent request growth since February

×1.2 human readership growth since February

Agents are not bots



Behavior	Crawler	Agent
Purpose	Indexes everything, indiscriminately	Working one person's task
Schedule	Continuous, scheduled crawl	Bursts, tied to a request
Outcome	An index entry	A decision -- install, cite, or skip

Breaking down agent jobs to be done



Agent Preference

Do coding agents find and choose your product when the user has a problem that you solve?

- **What product should I use to create and host my docs?**



Agent Experience

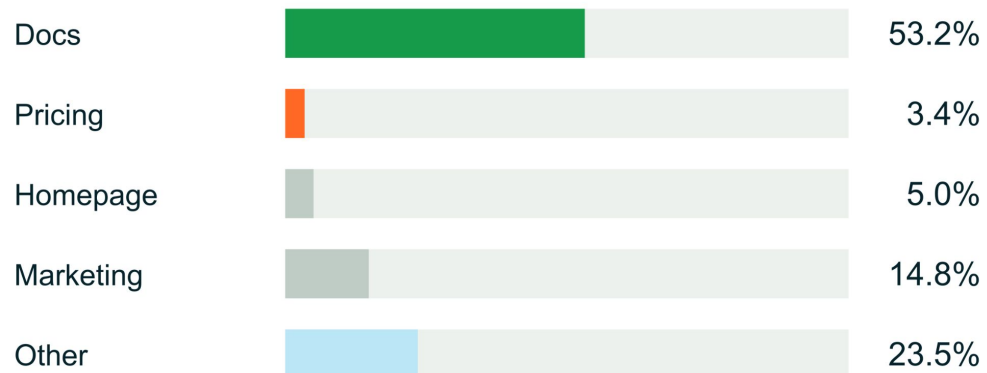
Can the agent complete and verify the task using your product?

- **Help me implement Mintlify for my codebase**

Agent Experience – Agents love docs

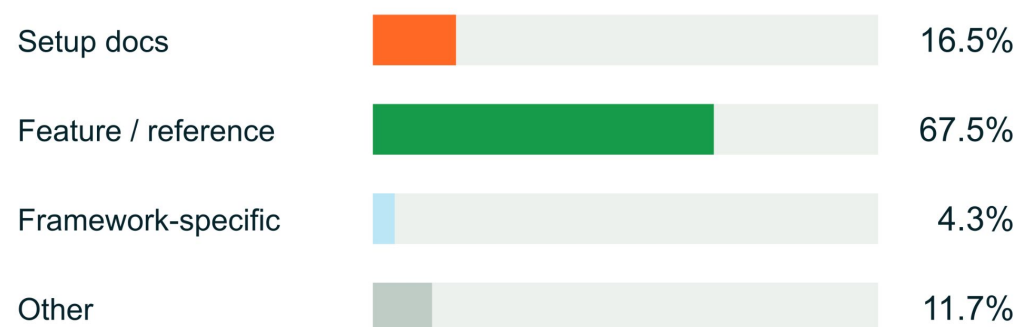
Gauge 🏆

Agent Experience: % of company-site fetches



Gauge 🏆

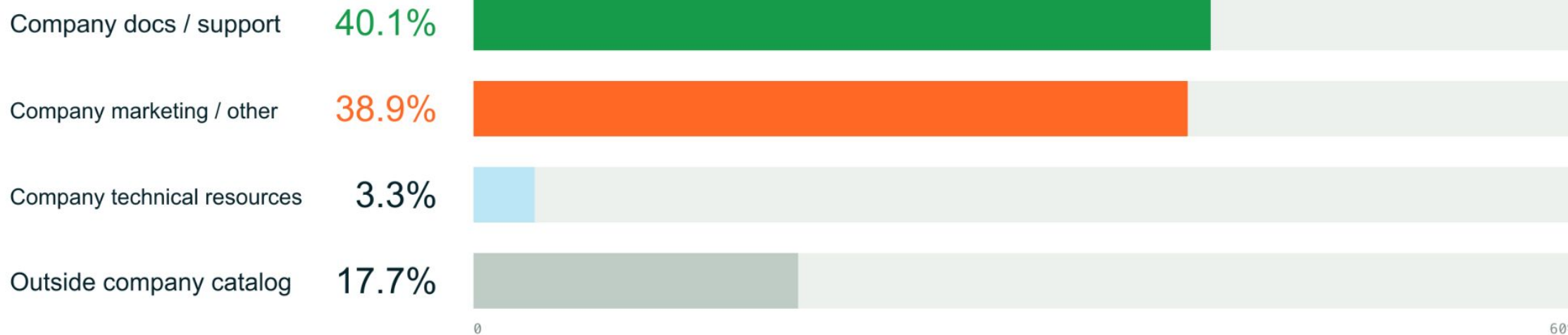
Agent Experience: docs breakdown



Agent Preference – Agents love docs

Gauge 🐾

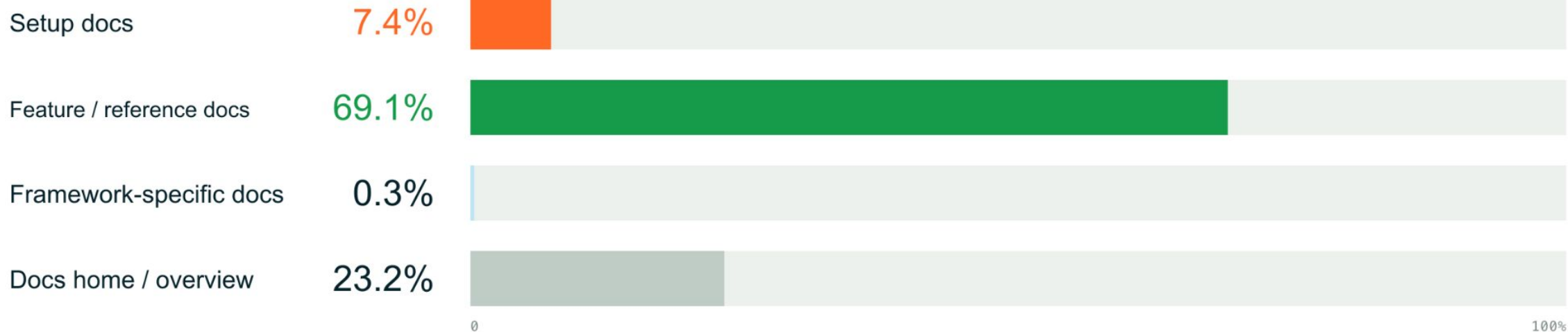
Open ended questions: % of all source fetches



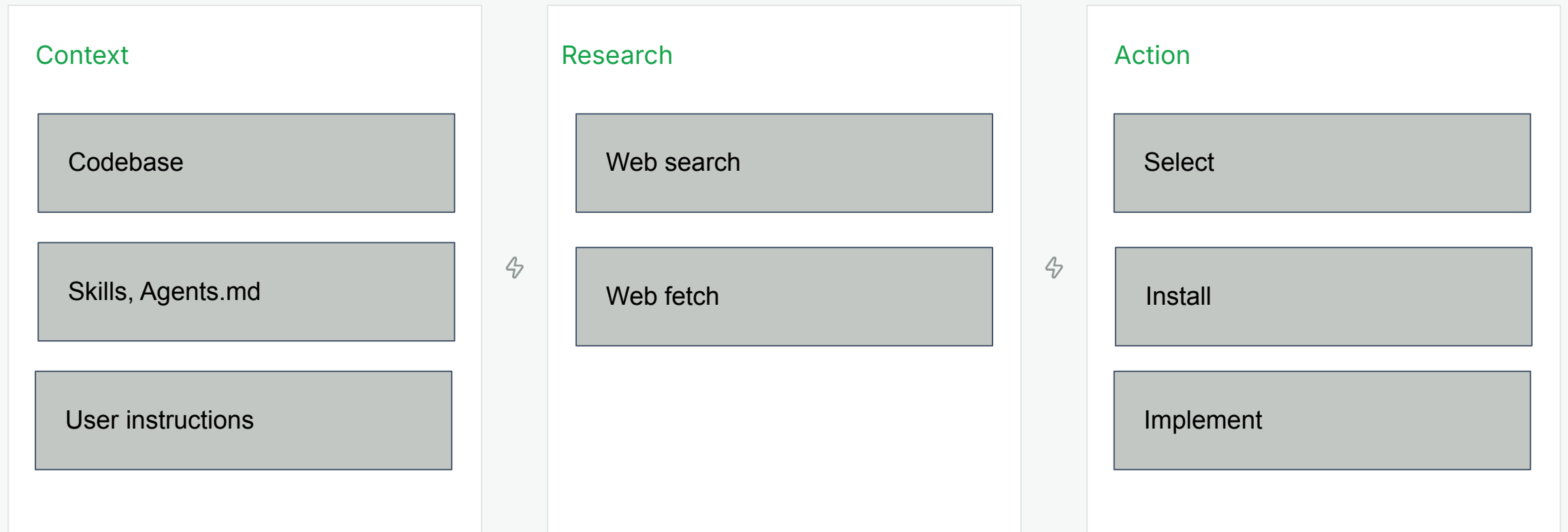
Agents want to know how your product works

Gauge 

Agent Preference: docs breakdown (URL-based)



How an agent decides



Agent Experience – Uses Docs

```
>_ OpenAI Codex (v0.142.5)
```

```
model:      GPT-5.6 Sol /model to change
```

```
directory:  algolia/docsearch
```

```
> Migrate our docs site from docusaurus to mintlify. You can find the docs page in /packages/website/docs.
```

```
Make sure to get us fully migrated. Start on the mintlify free tier to start, we'll look to upgrade later. Be sure to test with localhost to make sure the mintlify site renders correctly.
```

- search site:mintlify.com/docs mint.json docs.json navigation configuration local development CLI running...
- search site:mintlify.com/pricing free hobby plan Mintlify 2026 running...

Agent Preference – Uses Docs

```
>_ OpenAI Codex (v0.142.5)
```

```
model:      GPT-5.6 Sol /model to change
```

```
directory:  gauge-sh/acme-dispatch-nextjs
```

```
> We want to create a doc site to accompany our product and are looking at SaaS to handle the hosting. Please research the documentation products we should consider for this existing repo. What docs products would you recommend we use? Can you make one strong recommendation that we should consider most important? Don't write code yet; just research the products and explain your recommendation.
```

Key requirements are clear: Git-backed Markdown, a mixed product/API audience, a small engineering team, and no OpenAPI spec yet. I'm comparing hosted platforms that fit that reality rather than API-only portals.

- `search site:mintlify.com/docs pricing GitHub sync authentication analytics Mintlify documentation` Search results aren't included in Codex logs.
- `search site:readme.com/pricing ReadMe pricing Starter Pro Enterprise September 2026` Search results aren't included in Codex logs.
- `search site:mintlify.com/docs API reference OpenAPI MDX monorepo custom domain preview deployments` Search results aren't included in Codex logs.
GitHub
- `search site:mintlify.com/docs monorepo docs directory GitHub app project root` Search results aren't included in Codex logs.

What agents actually ask for



Markdown

A plaintext version of your page that's easy for agents to read.



llms.txt

One file listing every page and a description to help LLMs navigate your site.



83%

of agent traffic arrives through these routes,
not rendered pages



MCP

A protocol letting an AI app query your system directly, instead of reading pages.

llms.txt helps agents navigate your site well and more token efficiently

2,400 controlled tests, 20 docs sites

94–99%

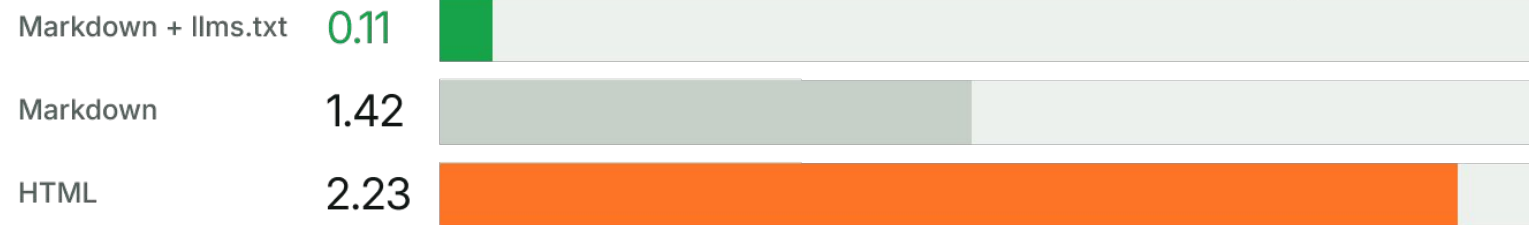
accuracy, held steady regardless
of format

20×

improvement over HTML, markdown +
llms.txt
26–60% fewer tokens consumed, across five
models

404s by docs format

AVERAGE # OF 404 ERRORS PER TASK; CLAUDE & CODEX



2,400 CONTROLLED TESTS ACROSS 20 DOCUMENTATION SITES

FIGURE 3

LLMs love llms.txt and .md pages

Over 100x
more likely
to visit

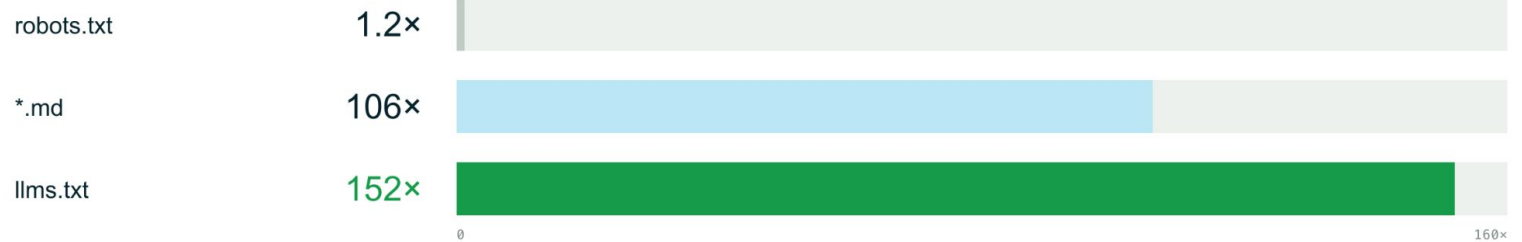
AI is much more likely to hit these
pages

 10.8M

llms.txt fetches in August; MCP calls passed
2M, ~3x since February

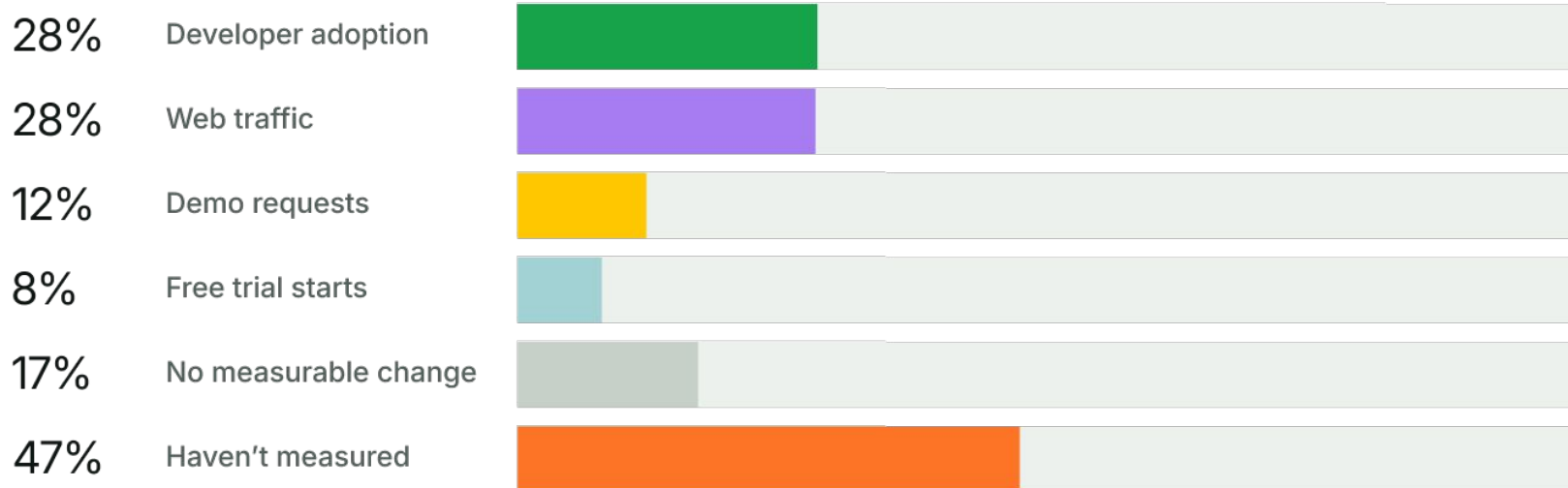
Gauge 🦊

AI traffic to pages relative to humans



Measuring the impact of improved documentation

Since improving your documentation's discoverability and structure with Mintlify, have you seen measurable changes in any of the following?

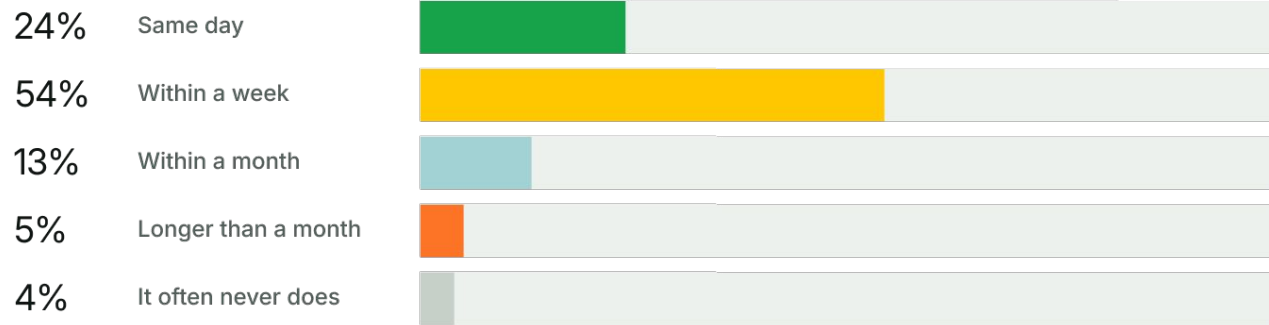


216 MINTLIFY CUSTOMERS

FIGURE 4

Keeping docs up to date

How long does a product change typically take to reach your documentation?



ALL 329 RESPONDENTS

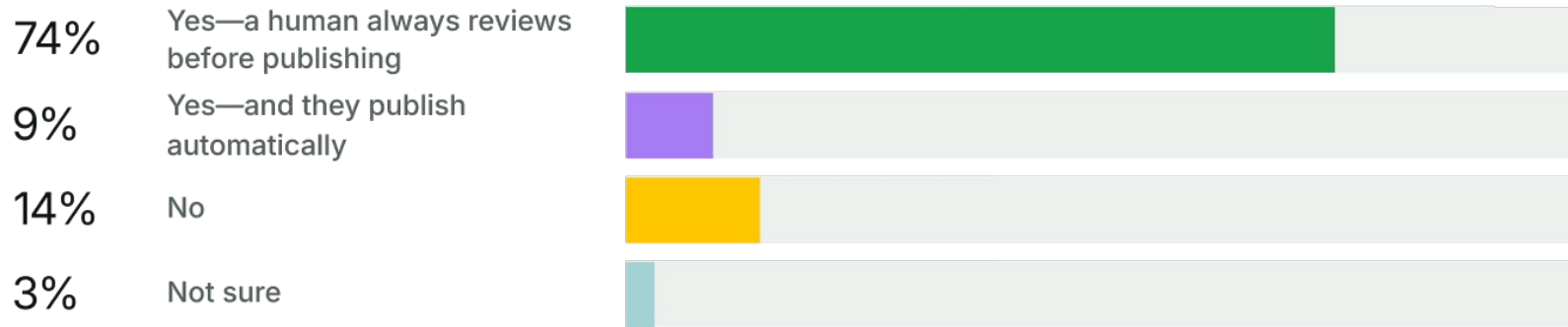
FIGURE 5

Merged PRs since 2023 (Source: Github)

3.6×

Agents drafting docs

Do AI agents draft documentation updates for your team?



ALL 329 RESPONDENTS

FIGURE 6

Agent docs iteration



A/B test documentation to find the right answer

1. Fly.io offers managed and unmanaged postgres databases
2. Agents were picking competitors over fly because they claimed it did not offer managed postgres
3. Fly.io tested documentation updates with Gauge to see if they changed agent behavior
4. Fly shipped update documentation to more prominently feature managed postgres
5. Fly.io started to win head to heads for hosted postgres

Knowledge readiness

94%

have surfaces beyond docs; over half have five or more

<1/3

call "most" or "all" of their knowledge agent-ready

35%

publish through four-plus tools -- 5× more likely to rate themselves behind

57%

have no clear owner for making non-docs knowledge agent-ready

The confidence gap

79%

rate their knowledge "about average" or "ahead of most companies"

7%

have made every surface they own readable by an agent

How to improve for agents

1. Keep documentation current and exhaustive
2. Have clear pricing that agents can understand
3. Anticipate that agents will make mistakes
4. A/B test how agents consume your docs and iterate
5. Have a robust llms.txt
6. Serve your pages as markdown with .md extensions
7. Invest in comparative content to make it clear where you and your competitors differ

Minimize the work the agent must do to implement your tool.

Benchmark your own docs

1. Run the URL discovery benchmark against your docs
2. Serve markdown *and* an llms.txt map -- markdown alone is half the job
3. Automate doc updates from code pushes and resolved tickets, human in the loop
4. Name an owner for one non-docs surface
5. Run unbranded prompts in your category and read what the agent picked

Mintlify Agent Score

mintlify.com/score



Gauge Agent Experience Check

ax-check.com



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Recording and slides follow by email.



mintlify.com/state-of-knowledge



Gauge 



withgauge.com/agents

